A-A-20070A
January 26, 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20070
November 23, 1982

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PEPPERS, GREEN AND RED, DEHYDRATED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Military Specification MIL-P-35003, Peppers, Green and Red, Dehydrated and Veterans Administration Specification X-1640/23a, Peppers, Green, Dehydrated.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers dehydrated green and red peppers, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government

Salient characteristics.

The dehydrated green and red peppers shall conform to the following types, styles, and classes of product specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Green
Type II - Red
Type III - Mixed red and green

Styles.

Style A - Diced 1/4 inch by 1/4 inch (approximate)
Style B - Diced 3/8 inch by 3/8 inch (approximate)

Classes.

Class 1 - With sulfite, 1,000 to 2,500 ppm, (extended shelf life)
Class 2 - Without sulfite, 0 ppm, (normal shelf life)

FSC 8915

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release, distribution is unlimited

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The peppers shall be properly matured, either green or red, sweet bell peppers of similar variety and dehydration characteristics. Peppers of the hot pungent variety shall not be used. The peppers shall be firm and free from defects caused by hail, scars, sunburn, disease, insects, or mechanical or other means, except for small holes or splits incident to proper handling procedures. The peppers shall be properly washed to remove soil, spray residue, and foreign material. Any diseased and seriously damaged units shall be discarded.

The peppers shall be cored and trimmed to remove seeds, seed cells, and rotted areas, then diced, with a minimum of tearing and rough cutting Peppers for Type I shall be a generally uniform green color with some variation from bright green to olive green. Peppers for Type II shall be a generally uniform red color with some variation from bright red to orange red after being properly trimmed and washed. Mixed green and red peppers for Type III shall consist of, by weight, not less than 35 percent generally uniform typical green pieces and not less than 35 percent generally uniform typical red pieces Sweet bell peppers which are in the process of turning from green to red, including shades of brown, are permitted provided the minimum percentages of strictly green and red pieces are present.

Finished product.

The dehydrated, sweet bell peppers shall be free from foreign material such as dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, paint, paper, glass, or metal, and shall be free from foreign odor or flavor such as burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy The moisture content of the dehydrated product by weight, prior to packaging, shall not exceed 5 0 percent for Type I, 7 5 percent for Type II, and 5 5 percent for Type III The sulfite level (calculated as sulfur dioxide) for Class 1 product shall be not less than 1,000 nor more than 2,500 parts per million (ppm) by weight Class 2 product shall not contain any sulfite Not more than 10 percent, by weight, of the dehydrated, sweet bell peppers shall pass through a U S Standard No 8 sieve There shall be not more than 25 seeds per 100 grams of dehydrated, sweet bell peppers The prevailing industry microbiological standards shall apply to this product

The rehydrated product shall possess the color, odor, flavor, and appearance typical of normal, sweet bell peppers and a texture that is tender, firm, full fleshed, but not mushy The sweet bell peppers shall rehydrate to approximately their original physical form when 1 0 ounce of the dehydrated product (on a dry solids basis) is added to 16 0 ounces of 35° to 55°F water, by weight, and allowed to soak for 2 hours at ordinary refrigerated temperature (approximately 40°F). The rehydrated product shall contain not more than 2 percent, by weight, of defective pieces such as those affected by scorch, hail, sunburn, disease, rot, insect or mechanical damage, stem, core, or

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placenta tissue. Not less than 95 percent, by weight, of the rehydrated Type I green, sweet bell peppers shall possess a generally typical green color with some variation from bright green to olive green. Not less than 95 percent, by weight, of the rehydrated Type II red, sweet bell peppers shall possess a generally uniform typical red color with some variation from bright red to orange red. The rehydrated Type III mixed red and green, sweet bell peppers shall consist of not less than 35 percent generally typical uniform green pieces and not less than 35 percent generally uniform typical red pieces, by weight. The balance of the pieces may be in the process of turning from green to red and may include pieces of varying shades of brown provided the color is natural and is not due to scorching.

Analytical requirements.

Chemical analyses shall be in accordance with the following methods as specified:

1 Moisture content test. Grind approximately 100 grams of a well mixed sample in a clean, dry Waring Blendor or similar mill for 1 minute. Weigh two samples, approximately 2.0 grams each of the ground material, into tared, dry aluminum weighing dishes (approximately 2 or 2 1/2 inches in diameter and 3/4 inch in depth) with tight-fitting covers. Place the dishes with cocked lids in a vacuum oven and dry for 16 hours at 60°C under a pressure of not more than 100 mm mercury. During drying, admit to the oven a slow current of air (approximately two bubbles per second) dried by passing through concentrated sulfuric acid Remove the dishes and allow them to cool in a desiccator before weighing. Calculate the percent of moisture in the original samples

2 Sulfur dioxide content test. Sulfur dioxide of the ground sample shall be determined in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Food Additives Direct, Section: Chemical Preservatives, Method: Sulfurous Acid in Food, Modified Monier-Williams

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID, conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery

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from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder

Quality assurance

When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that product quality and/or acceptability be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U S Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The product shall be examined and/or analyzed in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The dehydrated peppers shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer

A. Additional quality assurance.

1. Leakage test Five filled and sealed cans shall be selected at random from the lot The seams of the filled and closed cans shall be examined as follows Submerge can in water contained in a vacuum desiccator, Mead tester, or equivalent device, and draw a vacuum of 10 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure of 29.9 inches) for 30 seconds

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and observe for leakage. A leak consists of a steady progression of bubbles and shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Isolated bubbles that can be caused by the release of air entrapped in the double seam are not considered signs of leaks.

2. Oxygen content test. Five filled and sealed cans shall be selected at random from the lot. Oxygen content of headspace gas shall be determined in accordance with American Dry Products Institute publication, Bulletin 916, Standards for Grades of Dry Milk; Including Methods of Analysis: Determination of Oxygen. The result of each determination shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent for each can Alternatively, the headspace oxygen content may be determined by an Instrumentation Laboratories Oxygen Analyzer or equivalent instrument Test results shall be reported to the nearest 0 1 percent for each can The lot shall be rejected if any of the cans exceed 2.0 percent oxygen. When referee testing is necessary, the American Dry Products Institute method shall be followed

3. Screening examination. Five filled and sealed cans shall be selected at random from the lot. Weigh entire contents of can. Place approximately 2 ounces of dehydrated material on an 8-inch diameter, or approximately 4 1/2 ounces on a 12-inch diameter, U S Standard No 8 sieve Tip back and forth through a 90-degree arc 25 times Empty material remaining on sieve into an appropriate container and repeat this procedure until the entire contents of the can have been screened. Weigh total material passing through sieve and calculate percentages. Any nonconformance to requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot

B. Commercial packaging. Product shall be packaged into an open-top style, round, metal can, size 401 x 411 in accordance with good commercial practice The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.20 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate provided the cans have an exterior commercial coating. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product Desiccant in accordance with MIL-D-43266 and in quantities capable of lowering the moisture content of the product to that specified in Table I shall be included in each can All cans shall be hermetically sealed Product net weight, can sealing, and packaging requirements shall be as specified in Table I

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TABLE I. Packaging requirements

Product types	Net weight (Dry solids basis)	Maximum moisture content with desiccant	Nitrogen sealing requirement	Alternate sealing method
Type I	4.25 oz.	1.5 percent	N/A	N/A
Type II	7.5 oz.	2 5 percent	Not more than 2 percent oxygen 1/	Vacuum seal not less than 27 inches of mercury
Type III	5 4 oz	1 5 percent	Not more than 2 percent oxygen 1/	Vacuum seal not less than 27 inches of mercury

1/ When cans are closed under vacuum, the oxygen requirement is not applicable

C. Commercial packing. Twenty-four cans of product, packaged as specified in Table I, shall be packed in a manner to ensure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

D. Export packaging. Product shall be packaged into an open-top style, round, metal can, size 401 x 411 with a soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0 25 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate The entire inside area of the can shall be coated The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product The can shall be coated on the outside with a coating conforming to Type I, or when specified, Type III of TT-C-495

Desiccant in accordance with MIL-D-43266 and in quantities capable of lowering the moisture content of the product to that specified in Table I shall be included in each can All cans shall be hermetically sealed Product net weight, can sealing, and packaging requirements shall be as specified in Table I

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E. Export packing. Twenty-four cans of product, packaged as specified in Table I, shall be packed in a fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed on end four in length, three in width, and two in depth within a snug-fitting, shipping container. Tiered cans shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad made of the same material as the box. Reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

F. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

G. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable and shall also include the following:

DIRECTIONS FOR USE

Add 1 ounce (3/4 cup) dehydrated product to 16 ounces (1/2 quart) cool water. Allow to soak for 30 minutes if sweet peppers are to be used for cooking. Or allow to soak for 60 minutes or more (preferably overnight) in refrigerator if sweet peppers are to be used for salad preparation. Dehydrated, sweet bell peppers may be added to soups and stews without presoaking

NOTE: One ounce of dehydrated, sweet bell peppers equals 8 ounces of fresh, sweet bell peppers, as purchased; 6 1/2 ounces cut, green, sweet bell peppers, 5 ounces cut, red, sweet bell peppers; or 5 3/4 ounces cut, mixed green and red, sweet bell peppers, as applicable

H. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

Purchaser should specify product types, styles, and flavors

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Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists may be obtained from·

Association of Official Analytical Chemists
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400-CD
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

Copies of the Standards for Grades of Dry Milk, Including Methods of Analysis, Bulletin 916 may be obtained from

American Dry Products Institute
130 North Franklin Street
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199 This three-volume set may be purchased from

Superintendent of Documents
U.S Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (Master Charge or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

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Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairman
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID should be submitted to

U.S. Army Natick Research,
Development and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, CES
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES

DOJ - BOP
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

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